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MINI EBOOK

A Starter Guide to Better AI Prompts

A simple framework for turning broad requests into focused instructions—and refining a response without losing control of the result.

> **How to use this resource:** Choose one idea, adapt it to your needs, and review results carefully. AI tools can make mistakes; check important information and protect private details.

The five-part brief

- Task: describe the action—explain, compare, draft, organize, or critique.
- Context: give only background that changes the response.
- Audience: specify who will use or read the result.
- Constraints: set length, tone, source limits, or exclusions.
- Format: request a structure you can review and use.

From vague to useful

- Vague: “Help me with marketing.”
- Clearer: “I run a small [type] business. Suggest five low-cost ways to introduce [offer] to [audience] this month. For each, give a first step and a risk to check. Do not assume I have an ad budget.”
- The second version states a task, context, audience, boundary, and practical format. Replace the brackets with real details.

Give examples when style matters

- If you have an approved example, share a short non-sensitive excerpt and say which qualities to match: level of detail, tone, or structure.
- Do not ask a model to copy a person’s private voice or imitate a living creator; describe the general qualities you need instead.
- Separate source material from instructions, and tell the tool whether it may use outside knowledge or only your material.

Improve the first response

- Ask for alternatives rather than accepting the first draft.
- Point to a specific issue: “The steps are too broad; make each one actionable.”
- Ask the assistant to list assumptions, missing inputs, or claims you should verify.
- Review changes yourself; AI may confidently return inaccurate details.

A prompt you can reuse

- I need help with [task] for [audience]. Relevant background: [context]. Please respect these limits: [constraints]. Return the answer as [format]. Use only the information below for factual claims. Flag anything missing or uncertain. Source material: [paste non-sensitive material].

Practice and review

- Choose a low-stakes task, write a first prompt, and save the result.
- Add one useful detail—audience, example, or constraint—and try again.
- Compare which output better fits your goal. Note one check you still need to perform.
- Never share passwords or confidential records. Verify important factual, legal, medical, financial, and time-sensitive claims with reliable sources.

Educational resource prepared for personal learning. Adapt the worksheets to your own needs. AI output is not a substitute for professional advice in legal, medical, financial, or other high-stakes situations.